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Fandom of the Opera

We take our opera glasses to the coolest Web browser out there and come away with a treasure trove of tips, tricks and a sneak peek at its future

Ahmed Shaikh

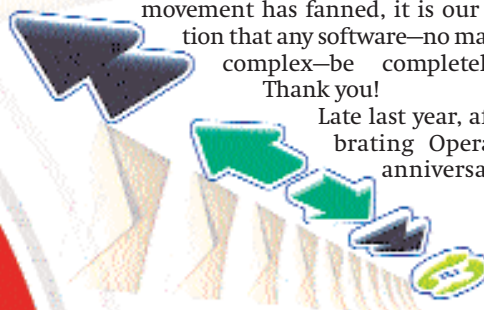
Over the past year or so, the online community has hit the reload button on The Browser Wars. 2005 witnessed the rise of Mozilla Firefox after years of sulking in Netscape's shadow. Today, the open source Firefox is a force to be reckoned with, drawing in a healthy sum of money for the Mozilla Foundation. For a free browser, that's quite a feat. It has also captured a good chunk of the market share, forcing Microsoft to rev up its Internet Explorer team and

launch a preliminary counterattack in the form of a beta release.

Hurrah for Firefox and all that, but amidst the din of Mozilla vs. Microsoft, the world seemed to have forgotten—or worse, ignored—a little gem from Norway called Opera. Historically, this was because Opera wasn't free as in beer. The unregistered version was marred by text and banner ads, and if there is one ill the open source movement has fanned, it is our expectation that any software—no matter how complex—be completely free.

Thank you!

Late last year, after celebrating Opera's 10th anniversary, the



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